

UNIT 1: INTRODUCTION TO GLOBALISATION

Class Time: 75 Minutes

Description

This lesson will allow the learner to understand their role in globalisation. The lesson begins with an exercise on understanding how everyone is affected by globalisation (See Activity 1: Global Bingo). We move from this introduction into a role play on the global economy where students adopt the role of a community member that is affected by the arrival of a multi-national corporation (See Activity 2: Mystery Jeans Inc.). This role play provides students with a first glance at the dominant players in the global economy and gives an excellent opening to the showing of a film and discussion on globalisation (See Activity 3: Video). The video selected summarises the global economy very succinctly and introduces the students to some of the world decision makers (IMF, WB, WTO). To end the unit, students are given a group assignment where they will be asked to evaluate the influence of various global corporations in the global economy.

Curriculum Expectations

Global BINGO

Specific Expectations

UC3.01 – identify awareness levels and viewpoints relating to a geographic issue by conducting a survey in the school or local community.

Mystery Jeans Inc.!

Specific Expectations

GC1.04 – demonstrate an understanding of how economies and environments in some places may be affected by decisions made in other places.

GC3.01 - demonstrate an understanding of how quality of life and employment prospects are related to the global economy.

GC3.02 – evaluate the performance of a selected transnational corporations with respect to the promotion of environmental sustainability and human rights.

UC3.02 – evaluate and communicate the perspectives and arguments of various stakeholders involved in a geographic issue.

Video

Overall Expectations

SSV.02 – analyse the causes and effects of economic disparities around the world.

Specific Expectations

SS2.04 – evaluate the significance of the participation of people in non-violent movements to protect resources and environments.

GC2.01 – analyse the economic and environmental consequences for selected countries of colonialism in the past and economic colonialism in the present.

GC3.01 – demonstrate an understanding of how quality of life and employment prospects are related to the global economy.

UC1.02 – explain how local participation in the development process can build sustainable communities.

Backstage of a Multi-National Corporation (Homework)

Overall Expectations

GCV.01 – demonstrate an understanding of the interdependence of countries in the global economy.

GCV.02 – analyse instances of international cooperation and conflict and identify factors that contribute to each.

Specific Expectations

HE2.06 – explain ways in which trade policies or agreements may affect the environment.

GC3.02 – evaluate the performance of a selected transnational corporation with respect to the promotion of environmental sustainability and human rights.

Prior Knowledge and Skills

- Awareness of concepts of international trade (e.g. export, import, global corporations).
- Some knowledge of global economic institutions and regulations (e.g. IMF, World Bank, WTO, GATT, NAFTA).
- Web searching, critical thinking, group work, GIS basic knowledge.

Planning Notes

- Photocopy the global bingo card (1 per student) (See Worksheet 1).
- Photocopy the Globalisation Fact sheet (See Globalisation Fact sheet).
- Photocopy Mystery Jeans Inc.! Role Cards and cut them to size (See Supplementary Sheet 2)
- Photocopy the homework sheet on Multi-National Corporations (See Worksheet 2).
- Find a film on globalisation that covers international economic institutions. Recommended film is: Global Village or Global Pillage from World Inter-Action Mondiale (See Supplementary Sheet 2).
- Review the glossary of terms and be prepared to define any for the class.

Teaching/Learning Strategies

Most of the learning strategies are described in each activity, but here are some of the overall strategies for the unit.

- Introduce students to the concept of the global economy.
- Examine the historical path of globalisation by identifying the policies and international commitments and the effects of the implementation of local, national, and global issues.
- Identify individuals who have made a significant contribution to globalisation.
- Introduce the students to new vocabulary and the new concepts listed in each activity. Refer them to the glossary.
- Refer the students to the accompanying material, the supplementary sheets, and where to go to find information.
- Assign students the suggested homework and encourage students to do an in-depth analysis of the information provided and to research the websites given for this unit.
- Monitor the group work and simulation games so the benefits are maximized for your students.

Accommodations

Frequent monitoring and assistance should be provided. Accommodations that are normally provided in the regular classroom for students with special needs should be provided. Here are some strategies for helping them.

- Information should be presented in as many modalities as possible through oral presentations, board notes, diagrams, class discussions, activity-based learning.
- Instructions should be clear, concise, to the point, verbally rehearsed by the student, properly sequenced, reviewed after a time lapse, written down on the board or in a notebook.
- Assignments should be outlined in writing, written in the students' homework/assignment book, written (and left) on the blackboard, broken down step by step with the teacher, rehearsed/modelled, and scheduled step by step.
- Questioning should be clear, concise, allowing for appropriate response time. Students need to organise their thoughts, match them with appropriate vocabulary, put them in correct syntax, sequence the ideas and finally express them with good speech. These skills are often taken for granted when teaching new concepts.
- Encourage students to question for clarification and additional information. Learn to speak at a lower rate of speech. Avoid figurative language unless it has been specifically pre-taught. Encourage and evaluate oral responses and class participation. Allow extra time (e.g. homework) for students to complete assignments that other students may finish in class time. Create extra practice opportunities with new vocabulary or concepts. Provide overviews or lesson highlights at the beginning of class. Discuss and simplify sophisticated vocabulary or language. Finally, give several short assignments rather than one long one.